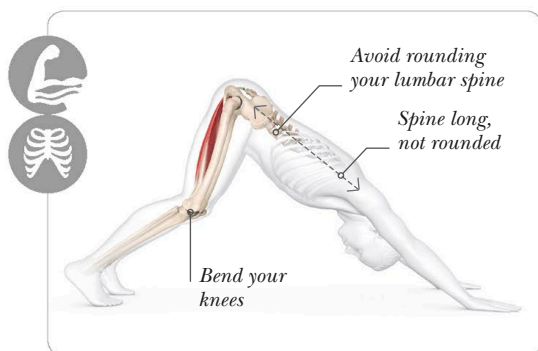


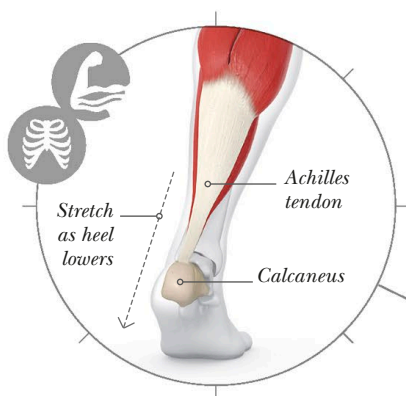
» CLOSER LOOK

Being too tight or too flexible can both present challenges when finding effective alignment in Downward-facing Dog. However, modifications can make it accessible for everyone.



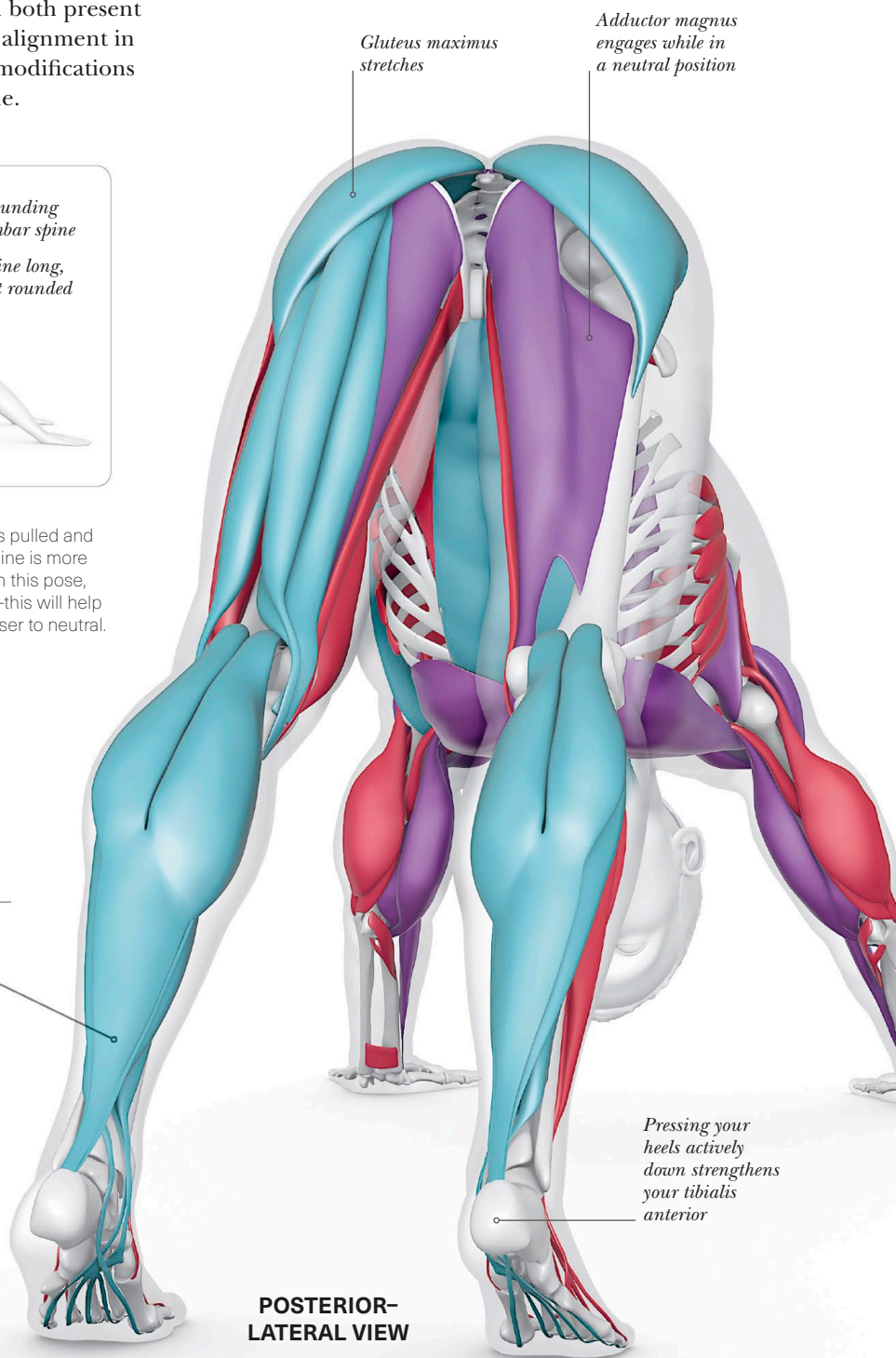
Tight hamstrings

When the hamstrings are tight, the pelvis is pulled and the back rounded. The integrity of your spine is more important than having your legs straight in this pose, so flex your knees and press into the floor—this will help lengthen your spine and bring the pelvis closer to neutral.



Achilles tendon

This tendon was named after the Greek mythological figure, Achilles, who only had one weakness: his calcaneal tendon. For many, it is very tight, preventing touching the heel to the ground in this pose. It can stretch with practice; however, there is some functional benefit to it maintaining tension as it stores potential energy.



POSTERIOR-LATERAL VIEW